Adaptability questions

Design Gurus

An earlier lesson asked you to write six or seven stories. This one turns that set into Amazon preparation without writing new ones.

Start from your stories, not from the list

The common mistake is to read the sixteen principles and try to invent a story for each. That produces sixteen thin stories, several of them invented, and all of them fragile under a follow-up question.

Do it the other way around. Take the stories you already have and ask, for each one, which principles it could evidence. A real project usually covers four or five.

Build the grid

Make a table with your stories down the side and the sixteen principles across the top. Mark every cell where the story genuinely shows that principle.

Genuinely is the word that matters. A story shows Dive Deep if you went and looked at the data yourself. It does not show Dive Deep because the project happened to involve a database.

When the grid is filled, three things become visible.

Your strongest stories. One or two will cover five or six principles. Know those best, because they are what you lead with.

Your empty columns. These are the principles that no story of yours evidences. That is the work.

Your overloaded stories. If one story covers eight principles, you are probably stretching it. A story used for everything sounds like it in the room. Four interviewers comparing notes will notice you told the same one three times.

Filling an empty column

You have three options, and they are not equally good.

Find a smaller real example. Usually the story exists and you never thought of it as a story, because the work felt ordinary. An afternoon spent reading logs instead of trusting a dashboard is a Dive Deep answer. It does not have to be a project.

Reframe a story you already have. The same project can be told with the emphasis moved. Your migration story is a Deliver Results answer if you put the number in front. It is a Bias for Action answer if you lead with the decision to start before the plan was finished.

Accept the gap and prepare an honest answer. If you have never hired anyone, say so and

give the closest thing, which is usually mentoring or interviewing. An honest adjacent answer scores better than an invented one, because the invented one collapses on the follow-up.

Show the principle without naming it

You do not need to announce which principle you are answering, and interviewers find it awkward when candidates do.

What helps is putting the evidence where it cannot be missed. Suppose the question is aimed at Ownership. The sentence "it was not my service, but nobody else was going to fix it before the weekend" does the work. The interviewer writes that sentence down.

How many stories you need

Six or seven, mapped across the grid, with no more than two empty columns among the commonly asked principles. That covers a full Amazon loop.

Preparing sixteen separate stories is common advice and it is bad advice. Almost nobody has sixteen strong stories, and the twelfth one will be weak enough to hurt you.